

HDTVs

The latest craze and a new test category for us this year. HDTVs are a very interesting product group and one that has captured the market. Falling prices, loads of misleading gyan...see the best, for there is no place for the rest.



Best Performer

LG 42-LG80FR and Sony KDL-70X3500

We even tested the new LG Jazz Theatre and while we really liked the colours there was noticeable banding in some of the video clips. The older 42-LG80FR didn't have this problem and also seemed to have a slightly better contrast ratio. Kudos to LG for a very good quality display at a very good price, this display is available for as little as Rs. 60,000 in lieu of newer, but not necessarily better models available. Even against the newer LED-based LCD TVs, we feel this display holds its own — the LED displays have some backlight response issues that just ruins the fun. The Sony KDL-70X3500 is another matter altogether. 70-inches of on-screen real estate is unheard of for an LCD TV, and there are few plasmas bigger than this, the most common sizes being 55 and 65-inches. That being said the KDL-70X3500 has excellent colour, contrast and brightness levels, very suitable for a home theatre system, but it's also uber expensive, (Rs. 20,00,000), so watch out.



Best Entry-level HDTV

Philips 32PFL5609/98

There was no winner in this category in our test conducted in March, simply because we felt no entry-level HDTV was worth its price. Manufacturers drop prices and the quality also falls disproportionately. In fact it's only now that we're seeing some better quality entrants in the sub-Rs. 40,000 category. The newcomer from

Philips proves a worthy buy indeed. At Rs. 38,000, this 32-inch display is of full-HD resolution, meaning it supports up to 1080p resolutions — very good performance for the price and a deserved Digit Zero 1 Award.

